dominating the PLA positions on the lower heights. This would also give us a clear view into their depth areas. Another two Companies were tasked to occupy the passes of Ane La and Kiu La, which was where all these fingers converged, which they did by the morning of the 30th. To the South, it was felt that the PLA may attempt some more actions since they had been pre-empted in the Chuti Changla area. Hence, a decision was taken to occupy Rezang La and Rechin La on the Kailash Range South of the Spanggur Gap, since this was the most obvious PLA response to our actions further North. Occupation of these additional positions would then dominate the Spanggur Gap from both North and South, denying the PLA any offensive options through this gap. Occupation of the two passes would not only give us observation into their depth areas and garrison at Moldo but also provide depth to our own location of Chushul.[1] These plans were put in motion—in fact, the orders were passed even while the meeting was in progress by Maj Gen RC Tiwari,[2] ADGMO(A), by telephone directly to the Army Commander, before anybody could change their mind.

The question of whether or not to open fire remained hanging. We (the Army) were of the opinion that protocols are fine but if they are being violated, then they become null and void. It is because of these protocols and the belief that we will not open fire, that the PLA was coming forward in large numbers in a non-tactical manner, reminiscent of their human-wave tactics. If this were to recur and our own positions were overrun, then the question would again be asked as to why, if we were armed, were we not opening fire in the face of such blatant acts of aggression. As it is, some reports had appeared in the media that our own personnel, especially at Galwan, were unarmed. This report was categorically denied. Troops moving out of their operating base go out armed and

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